

SECURING THE CLOUD

Enterprises should focus on fundamental security policies and procedures necessary to protect their systems. “To begin with, a configuration management database is imperative, with visibility into who has access to what and whether access is being monitored and audited,” says Anant Adya, EVP of Infosys Cobalt, a group within Infosys that helps businesses with their cloud-led transformation. Running vulnerability scans and developing a plan to address those vulnerabilities is also critical, along with identifying end-of-life/end-of-support technologies.

“Another crucial approach is the adoption of a zero-trust model. The model... requires explicit verification of all relevant factors before granting access,” says Ranganath Sadasiva, CTO at enterprise IT solutions provider HPE India. The model involves implementing the principle of least privilege, risk-based authentication built on network segmentation, con-

700+ clients spanning large- and mid-market enterprises across sectors. The company has deployed a full-fledged security information and event management solution that automates the complete remediation process. “Our network analytics and intelligence platform analyses 25 million traffic-flow records from around the world every minute. This enables us to proactively detect and prevent approximately 2.6 million threats per day, globally,” says Rajesh Awasthi, VP and Global Head of Managed Hosting and Cloud at Tata Communications. Experts also emphasise the need to keep cloud infrastructure, applications, and systems up to date with the latest security patches to avoid any breach.

IS INDIA PREPARED?

A lack of awareness among enterprises plays an integral role in companies not deploying sufficient security measures for their IT systems. Sundar Balasubramanian, MD of Check Point Software Technologies, India & SAARC says, “Limited awareness, budget constraints, misaligned priorities, trust concerns, and compliance requirements are some potential reasons for companies hesitating to invest in cloud security.” He adds that raising awareness among companies around cloud security risks, offering cost-effective solutions, building trust in service providers, and ensuring compliance with regulations are crucial.

The lack of a data protection law also hampers cloud security. Amit Jaju, Senior MD of Ankura Consulting Group (India) that helps firms mitigate the risks associated with cloud computing, estimates that the “average spending on cloud security in India among large-cap companies, SMEs and start-ups ranges from \$1-5 million, \$100,000-\$1 million, and \$50,000-\$100,000, respectively.” Jaju adds that it can be difficult for companies to know what they need to do to protect their data when there are no clear regulations and guidelines. “This can lead to complacency and a lack of investment in security measures.”

However, recent advisories by regulators and government agencies have reiterated the need to deploy robust cybersecurity measures and incident response systems for everyone from mainstream organisations to emerging fintech companies, start-ups and SMEs.

Whatever the reasons, it is only by adopting a comprehensive cybersecurity approach that organisations in India can mitigate risks, safeguard sensitive data, and ensure the resilience of their digital infrastructure in the face of an expanding threat landscape. **BT**

@nidhisingal

MONEY MATTERS

Average spending on cloud security in India per annum

Large-cap companies	\$1 million-5 million
SMEs	\$100,000-1 million
Start-ups	\$50,000-100,000

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tinuous monitoring for signs of attacks, and active defence mechanisms.

Businesses should also conduct regular security assessments and penetration tests to identify vulnerabilities. “These tests simulate real-world attack scenarios and help organisations identify and remediate weaknesses proactively,” says Monisha Oberoi, Asia Pacific Security Services Leader at IBM Consulting. In addition, maintaining continuous monitoring of cloud environments and leveraging threat intelligence feeds to stay informed about emerging threats and attack techniques also enables proactive threat detection and response, she adds.

Having a robust security framework is advisable. Take for instance Tata Communications that has over